NIHR | National Institute for Health and Care Research

Summary

Reference Number	NIHR306150
Lead Applicant	Dr Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk
Research Title	NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award Cohort 5
Total Research Cost	.00

Our purpose for collecting this data is to communicate with you about your application and have the necessary information to evaluate you for a grant. The data we collect here is collected in the public interest. Information provided here may be subject to Freedom of Information requests.

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The NIHR privacy policy includes further information including ways we may use your data, our contact details and details on your individual rights regarding how your data is used. Your data may be shared across the NIHR, including with other coordinating centres, to allow the application to be managed and for statistical analysis, and with external grant reviewers as part of the process for managing the allocation of a grant. This notice is under constant review and will be updated and / or revised based on that review as appropriate.

Table Of Contents

1. NIHR DSE Award Introduction
2. Application Summary Information
3. Lead Applicant
4. Support and Mentorship
5. Budget Summary
6. Detailed Budget
7. Uploads
8. Participants and Signatories
9. Acknowledgement, Review and Submit
10. Validation Summary

1. NIHR DSE Award Introduction

	NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award Cohort 5

NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award Application Form

Please note that the following information and guidance are intended for applicants applying to the NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award ONLY.

The Applicant Guidance for the Development and Skills Enhancement award contains guidance and information about eligibility and the review process. These guidance notes can be accessed on the left-hand side of this page or via the (NIHR website).

Applying for the Development and Skills Enhancement Award is a single-stage application process. Before starting an application**, please ensure you carefully read the Guidance Notes and submit the required information for this application.**

When completing this application, you are advised to validate your application as you progress through the various sections. You will find a **'Validation Summary'** option in the left-hand menu. This section will detail any points within your application that are either incomplete or incorrect. If any section of the application is not fully validated, you will not be able to press the **'Submit'** button.

Please ensure your application is submitted before the current submission window closes on Friday 22nd November 2024 at 1pm to be considered. Please refer to the Guidance notes for more information on submission windows.

Completing and submitting your application form:

Applicant:
You will only be able to press the **'Submit'** button, which will send the application for final sign-off by the signatories when:

- all mandatory sections of the application form are complete;
- all participants have agreed to be part of your application;
- the signatory has agreed to their role;

Required Participants :

- **Mentor(s):** The individual(s) providing mentorship must confirm that they have read the application and the guidance notes are willing to act as your mentor for career development and agree to abide by the conditions under which an award may be granted. If you have included external collaboration in your application for example with a CTU, Industry or Health data science they must confirm their participation in this section of the application.

- **Partner Organisation representative (if applicable):** The representative of the Partner Organisation must confirm that they support this application.

- **Host Organisation Administrative Authority or Finance Officer:** The Administrative Authority or Finance Officer for the Host Organisation must confirm that they will ensure the accuracy of the financial details of the application and that the Host Organisation is prepared to carry out this research at the stated costs and to administer the award that is made.

Required Signatory:

- **Head of Department / Senior Manager – Contracting Organisation**

Participants and signatories must confirm their participation in your application before you will be able to press the Submit button. Participants will have no further action to take in the submission process. It is recommended that you contact your participants and signatories as early as possible to ensure they understand any action they must take and will be available to sign off when you submit.

Once the application is ready (see list of required steps under the 'Applicant' heading above), you will be able to **'Submit'** the application for final sign-off by the signatory. At this point, the signatory will be prompted to log back into the system and approve the finalised application. **The application will not be submitted to the NIHR for consideration until the required signatory has approved the final version.**

Please ensure your application is submitted before the current submission window closes on Friday 22nd November 2024 at 1pm to be considered. Please refer to the Guidance notes for more information on submission windows.

Should you require assistance in completing the online form, please contact the NIHR Academy on 0113 532 8410 or by emailing academy-awards@nihr.ac.uk

Click on the link below for further information regarding the Application Form Submission Process

2. Application Summary Information

Contracting Organisation	University College London

Will you be adding a Partner Organisation?	Yes

Partner organisation	The Anna Freud Centre

Start Date	01/04/2025

Duration	26

% FTE commitment	70

Percentage of award time undertaking practice/clinical work
0.00

Has this application been previously submitted to this or any other funding body?	Yes

Grant reference Please provide the Grant Reference for the previously submitted application.
NIHR305716

Funder Search for the funding organisation from the ROR Website
NIHR

Please provide details	This submission is an invited re-submission see additional upload

Partnership Fellowship	(Select)

3. Lead Applicant

A CV for the Applicant is a mandatory component of this application; please ensure this is completed fully.
Please note that some of the CV questions are automatically completed from information you have provided in the 'Update CV' section of the 'Manage My Details' page. These can be updated via the ARAMIS Home Page or by following this link https://aramis.nihr.ac.uk/MyAccount/UpdateCV.aspx

Title	Dr		
First Name	Kim		
Last Name	Alyousefi-van Dijk		
Organisation	The Anna Freud Centre		
Department	CEO Projects		
ORCID iD	0000-0001-5705-6732	**ORCID Web Link**	https://orcid.org/0000-0001-5705-6732

Degrees and Professional Qualifications

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class
02/2016	06/2021	PhD	Neurobiology of early parenthood	Netherlands	Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	NA
09/2011	12/2014	MSc	Brain and Cognitive Sciences	Netherlands	Universiteit of Amsterdam	NA
09/2008	07/2011	BSc	Psychology (Cognitive Neuroscience)	Netherlands	Universiteit of Amsterdam	NA
09/2007	07/2010	BSc	Psychobiology	Netherlands	Universiteit of Amsterdam	NA

Present and previous positions
(including from/to dates, job title and employer)

From	To	Position	Organisation	WTE % Research
10/2024	-	Seminar Lead - BSc Psychology	University College London	0
04/2021	07/2022	Research and Evaluation Manager	Anna Freud Centre	20
03/2021	-	Trial Manager	Anna Freud Centre	91
03/2021	-	Visiting Researcher	Imperial College London	0
03/2021	-	Honorary Research Fellow	University College London	0
02/2016	06/2021	PhD Candidate	Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam	100
12/2013	02/2016	Research Assistant	Department of Psychiatry, Academic Medical Centre Amsterdam	50
12/2013	02/2016	Research Assistant	Netherlands Brain Bank for Psychiatry	50
09/2013	06/2014	Research Intern	Department of Psychiatry, Academic Medical Centre Amsterdam	100
02/2012	07/2021	Research Intern	Department of Clinical Neurophysiology, Universiteit Twente	100
01/2010	07/2010	Research Intern	Department of Brain & Cognition, University of Amsterdam	100

Research Grants held

Title of Grant	Role in the Research Grant	Total Grant £	Source of Grant (Organisation Name)	Duration (In Months)	Start Date of Funding	End Date of Funding
INTEGRATE	The INTEGRATE Project – role: Co-Applicant A project to develop an implementation framework for piloting a low-intensity, perinatal mental health workforce integrated in UK NHS maternity services.	29959	The Royal Foundation Centre for Early Childhood	5	01/10/2024	28/02/2025
The CAEP study (Child Abuse Experiences in new Parents)	Chief Investigator of a Mental Health for All: Springboard Funding Award The CAEP study (Child Abuse Experiences in new Parents): a project to explore how new parents' socio-economic inequalities and experience of child abuse affect their mental health and family relationships	10000	NIRH ARC North Thames	12	01/06/2023	30/06/2024

Publication Record

This should display the authors, date, article title and journal name for each publication added. This information can be edited via the "My Research Outputs" page of your ARAMIS account.

Publications
(2024) 'Alyousefi-Dijk, K., Fonagy, P., Rosan, C., Cornelius, V. R., Dr, Darwin, Z., Pilling, S., … R. The COSI study: a multi-site randomised controlled trial (RCT) to explore the clinical and cost effectiveness of the Circle of Security Intervention for mothers in perinatal mental health services. https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/T59NX',
Thijssen, S., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., de Waal, N., van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2024) 'Neural processing of cry sounds in the transition to fatherhood: Effects of a prenatal intervention program and associations with paternal caregiving.', *Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 164.
(2023) 'Alyousefi-van Dijk, K. The CAEP study (Child Abuse Experiences in new Parents). https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/D8UM6',
Rosan, C., Dijk, KA., Darwin, Z., Babalis, D., Cornelius, V., Phillips, R., Richards, L., Wright, H., Pilling, S., Fearon, P., Pizzo, E. and Fonagy, P.. (2023) 'The COSI trial: a study protocol for a multi-centre, randomised controlled trial to explore the clinical and cost-effectiveness of the Circle of Security-Parenting Intervention in community perinatal mental health services in England.', *Trials*, 24(1).
de Waal, N., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., Buisman, RSM., Verhees, MWFT. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2022) 'The prenatal video-feedback intervention to promote positive parenting for expectant fathers (VIPP-PRE): Two case studies.', *Infant mental health journal*, 43(5).
Buisman, RSM., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., de Waal, N., Kesarlal, AR., Verhees, MWFT., van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2022) 'Fathers' sensitive parenting enhanced by prenatal video-feedback: a randomized controlled trial using ultrasound imaging.', *Pediatric Research*, 93(4).
Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ., Verhees, MWFT., Lotz, AM., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K. and van IJzendoorn, MH.. (2022) 'Is paternal oxytocin an oxymoron? Oxytocin, vasopressin, testosterone, oestradiol and cortisol in emerging fatherhood.', *Philosophical transactions of the Royal Society of London. Series B, Biological sciences*, 377(1858).
Horstman, LI., Riem, MME., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., Lotz, AM. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2022) 'Fathers' involvement in early childcare is associated with amygdala resting-state connectivity.', *Social cognitive and*

Publication Record

This should display the authors, date, article title and journal name for each publication added. This information can be edited via the “My Research Outputs” page of your ARAMIS account.

Publications
affective neuroscience, 17(2).
Lotz, AM., Buisman, RSM., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., Witte, AM., Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ. and Verhees, MWFT.. (2022) ‘Exploring the role of endocrine factors in sensitive parenting in men.’, *Hormones and behavior*, 140.
Verhees, MWFT., van IJzendoorn, MH., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., Lotz, AM., de Waal, N. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2021) ‘Child maltreatment affects fathers' response to infant crying, not mediated by cortisol or testosterone.’, *Comprehensive psychoneuroendocrinology*, 8.
Riem, MME., Lotz, AM., Horstman, LI., Cima, M., Verhees, MWFT., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2021) ‘A soft baby carrier intervention enhances amygdala responses to infant crying in fathers: A randomized controlled trial.’, *Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 132.
Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., De Waal, N., Van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2021) ‘Development and feasibility of the prenatal video-feedback intervention to promote positive parenting for expectant fathers.’, *Journal of reproductive and infant psychology*, 40(4).
Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., van der Knaap, N., Buisman, RSM., Horstman, LI., Lotz, AM., Riem, MME., Schuengel, C., Van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2020) ‘White matter integrity moderates the relation between experienced childhood maltreatment and fathers' behavioral response to infant crying.’, *Developmental psychobiology*, 63(5).
Dijk, KA., Thijssen, S., van 't Veer, AE., Buisman, RSM., van IJzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, M.. (2020) ‘Exploring the transition into fatherhood: behavioral, hormonal, and neural underpinnings of responses to infant crying’,
Lotz, AM., Rijlaarsdam, J., Witteman, J., Meijer, W., van Dijk, K., van Ijzendoorn, MH. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2020) ‘Vasopressin and parental expressed emotion in the transition to fatherhood.’, *Attachment & human development*, 23(3).
Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ., Lotz, A., Alyousefi-van Dijk, K. and van IJzendoorn, M.. (2019) ‘Birth of a Father: Fathering in the First 1,000 Days.’, *Child development perspectives*, 13(4).
Alyousefi-van Dijk, K., van 't Veer, AE., Meijer, WM., Lotz, AM., Rijlaarsdam, J., Witteman, J. and Bakermans-Kranenburg, MJ.. (2019) ‘Vasopressin Differentially Affects Handgrip Force of Expectant Fathers in Reaction to Own and Unknown Infant Faces.’, *Frontiers in behavioral neuroscience*, 13.
‘Assessing parent-infant bonding in a community perinatal mental health service.’,

Relevant Prizes, Awards and other Academic Distinctions

Please note the information for additional prizes or awards is automatically populated from information provided in the "Update CV" section of the "Manage My Details" page, which you can update by following this link https://aramis.nihr.ac.uk/MyAccount/UpdateCV.aspx

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant
01/06/2024	Society for Reproductive and Infant Psychology	Full conference bursary: £490	Early Career Researchers - symposium chair&speaker

Lead Applicant Professional Background	Not a Health or Care Practitioner

Profession (Not A Health or Care	Other Research Scientist

Practitioner)	

Professional Registration	

Research Degree Status	Awarded

Date of award of research degree	22/06/2021

Contextual Factors
Please use this section to detail any factors that may have impacted the development of your research career or outputs from your research career to date. NIHR requests information on such circumstances so that the Committees may take them into consideration during the assessment of your application. Contextual factors could include:

- Career breaks due to parental leave, or periods of illness.
- Reduced time spent undertaking research activities (including research outputs), due to disability or to caring responsibilities. This may include physical or mental health-related impairments or conditions, which have impacted your opportunities to undertake research activities
- Reduced opportunities for career support e.g. mentorship, and limited opportunities to undertake prior research and training.
- Impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on your research career

Please also use this section to detail any other factors that may have impacted your research career not listed in the examples provided. The impact on your career to date will be specific to your particular circumstances but could include such impacts as limited opportunities to obtain grant funding or fewer publications. In general terms, contextual factors should be significant, and relevant.

NIHR acknowledges that you may be reluctant, or uncomfortable disclosing relevant information that is sensitive. However, you should bear in mind that we are unable to take into account factors that you do not disclose. Please be assured that the information provided by you is sensitive and will be treated confidentially and in line with the General Data and Protection Regulations (GDPR).

Completion of the contextual factors section of the application form does not automatically comprise a request for reasonable adjustments, and if adjustments are required we recommend that applicants reach out to the relevant programme team directly.

There have been several contextual factors affecting my academic career and I appreciate the Selection Committee taking these into account. Since starting my PhD in 2016, I have given birth to my two wonderful children and have taken maternity leave which has caused some delays in completion of my PhD. Our family then moved to the UK just before the pandemic. During the pandemic, nursery closures and home schooling has put considerable constraints on dedicated time for research activities such as writing up funding application and publications. In addition, I have myself experience serious mental health difficulties after the birth of my second child and was forced to take some time off work to recover.

4. Support and Mentorship

/ EDIT SUPPORT AND MENTORSHIP 1

Full Name	Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy

Organisation	Cheshire and Merseyside Specialist Perinatal Service

Email Address	Ruth.OShaughnessy@merseycare.nhs.uk

Role	Mentor

Description of Support Provided
Ruth O'Shaughnessy is a Consultant Clinical Psychologist and Co-Clinical Lead for the award-winning Cheshire and Merseyside Specialist Perinatal Service and for the North West Coast Perinatal Clinical Network. She has published numerous academic papers and book chapters in the field of attachment, perinatal, and parental mental illness. Importantly, she has substantial clinical and academic experience in the field of perinatal mental health inequalities, barriers to service access and treatment uptake as well as parenting across cultures, e.g. she co-authored the service-wide guidance on opening up conversations about race, ethnicity and culture. She also has extensive experience of supervising early to mid-career professionals. During the placement, Dr O'Shaughnessy will provide frequent one-to-one supervision meetings focussing on clinical and equalities aspects of the advanced fellowship proposal. Additionally, Dr O'Shaughnessy is ideally placed to introduce me to a wide range of professionals with extensive experience of culturally-sensitive and trauma-informed implementation of evidence-based therapies in NHS PMHS. The various research group meetings she chairs, or is involved in, will form great opportunities for gaining feedback on the fellowship proposal.

/ EDIT SUPPORT AND MENTORSHIP 2

Full Name	Professor Rachel Hiller

Organisation	University College London & Anna Freud Centre

Email Address	r.hiller@ucl.ac.uk

Role	Mentor

Description of Support Provided
Professor Rachel Hiller leads the Child Trauma and Recovery Research Group at UCL as a professor of Child & Adolescent Mental Health and is the head of postgraduate studies at the Anna Freud Centre. Professor Hilller's research focusses on the identification of key psychological and social processes linking trauma and maltreatment experiences to mental health. Additionally, she has expertise on the development and testing of scalable mental health intervention for trauma-exposed young people and the implementation within and across social care and mental health services. Importantly, Professor Hiller is renowned for co-developing mixed-methods research across sectors that have typically not been represented in research. Currently, professor Hiller leads multiple trials, including the MRC-funded ADaPT trial and the NIHR-ARC-funded ReThink project. Importantly, she has extensive experience in the supervision and mentoring of early career researchers. During the placement, Professor Hiller will provide frequent one-to-one supervision meetings focussing on applied, mixed methods, cross-sector research in the field of complex trauma. The various research group meetings she chairs, or is involved in, will form great opportunities for gaining feedback on the fellowship proposal. Additionally, access to the participation teams within Anna Freud will provide a valuable resource for co-development of future

projects.

/ EDIT SUPPORT AND MENTORSHIP 3

Full Name	Professor Carmine Pariante

Organisation	King's College London

Email Address	carmine.pariante@kcl.ac.uk

Role	Mentor

Description of Support Provided
Professor Pariante is Professor of Biological Psychiatry at the Institute of Psychiatry, Psychology and Neuroscience, KCL, and Consultant Perinatal Psychiatrist at the South London and Maudsley NHS Foundation Trust. He has received multiple awards, including the 2017 Andrea Leadsom Award for Outstanding Contribution to the Field of Infant Mental Health. Professor Pariante's research focusses on the role of stress and inflammation in the development of mental disorders and has a particular interest in the perinatal period. Currently, Professor Pariante works on multiple projects, including the NIHR-funded Maudsley Biomedical Research Centre; the MRC-funded CELEBRATE; and the Technology Strategy Board-funded HappyMums: understanding, predicting, and treating depression in pregnancy to improve mothers and offspring mental health outcomes. During the placement, Professor Pariante will provide frequent one-to-one supervision aiming to discuss clinical and neurobiological aspects of the advanced fellowship proposal. In addition, professor Pariante's expertise in accessible dissemination of mental health research will aid in the development of future dissemination plans through an in-depth introduction to his award-winning online magazine.

/ EDIT SUPPORT AND MENTORSHIP 4

Full Name	Professor Helen Sharp

Organisation	Liverpool University

Email Address	hmsharp@liverpool.ac.uk

Role	Mentor

Description of Support Provided
Professor Helen Sharp leads the Perinatal, Infant and Child Mental Health research group in the Department of Primary Care and Mental Health at Liverpool University. She is a practising Consultant Clinical Psychologist and currently leads the MRC-funded longitudinal study 'The Bangalore Child Health and Development Study' which aims to identify shared and distinctive risk and protective factors for child mental health, including early parenting, in the UK and India. She is the mental health lead for 'Children Growing Up in Liverpool', focussing on identifying mechanisms underlying inequalities of child development outcomes. Professor Sharp was the National Chair of the Faculty of Perinatal Psychology, British Psychological Society for five years advising government, Heath Education England and NHS England on policy and workforce development for perinatal mental health. She co-authored the Royal College of Psychiatry 2018 (Framework for Routine Outcome Measures in Perinatal Psychiatry CR216). She leads an active MRC GCRF programme grant with a team evaluating the predictive consequences of perinatal mental health, early adversities and parenting quality for child outcomes across cultures During the placement, Professor Sharp will provide frequent one-to-one supervision aiming to discuss the clinical, equalities and parent-infant relational aspects of the fellowship proposal.

5. Budget Summary

Lead Applicant Salary Cost	£111544

Training and Development Cost	£8445

Travel and Subsistence Cost	£1500

Justification of Summary Budget
The lead applicant has worked with University College London (UCL) as a post-doctoral research fellow for a number of years now. Given her strong track record of impactful academic publications, securing funding and overall academic success, a starting point of the lower band of a senior research fellow is deemed appropriate by the Head of the Division of Psychology and Language Sciences at UCL. The £3000 super visions costs are included within the 'Training and Development Cost'.

Total Summary Budget Requested
£121,489.00

6. Detailed Budget

Please note: Access to complete this page will be given if your application is successful

The finance section should provide a breakdown of costs associated with undertaking the Fellowship as described in the proposal.

This section must be completed by the Applicant in conjunction with the Research Support Office or Finance Office at the host organisation.

In this section only include funding requested from NIHR, any matched funding should be detailed in the host's supporting statement.

Details of Posts and Salaries

Direct Costs
These are the costs that are specific to the Fellowship, which will be charged as the amount actually spent and can be supported by an audit record.

Travel, Subsistence and Conference Fees
No costs have been added

Training And Development
No costs have been added

Summary

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total Cost (£)
Travel-subsistence-and-conference-fees	0	0	0	0
Training And Development	0	0	0	0
Total	0	0	0	0

7. Uploads

General Upload Section Guidance:

To upload a document click on the icon next to the relevant upload type. All mandatory uploads must be added for you to submit your application. Only .pdf document types can be uploaded. Any other document types will need to be converted to PDF format before uploading.

If you wish to remove or replace any specific documents all versions of that document will need to be deleted. Where a template is specified against an upload type, you must download the template, and complete the information required **without changing the headings**, and upload it back to this page.

When you are uploading a document to your application form, please ensure that it is in Adobe PDF format. It is not possible to upload a JPEG image or Excel spreadsheet to your application. If you try to upload a JPEG or Excel file, it will not attach to your application. Please refer to the Guidance Notes for information on the attachments required:

(Research Plan - Alyousefi 241122 Research Plan v2.0.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

(Career Development Programme - Alyousefi 241122 Career Development Programme.V3.0.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

(Gantt Chart or Project Management Plan - Gantt chart DSE award - K Alyousefi-van Dijk.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

LETTERS OF SUPPORT 1
(ICTU Letter of Support (DSE Alyousefi-van Dijk) - ICTU letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - Jul 2024) - signed.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

LETTERS OF SUPPORT 2
(Host Support Letter - DSE Alyousefi-van Dijk - UCL (host) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024) signed.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

LETTERS OF SUPPORT 3
(Parter organisation letter of support (DSE Alyousefi-van Dijk) - AFC (partner) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024).pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

LETTERS OF SUPPORT 4
(Prof Rachel Hiller (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 21.11.2024) signed.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

(Narrative CV - Alyousefi 241122 Narrative CV Personal Career Development Awards(2).pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

(Flexible Upload - Alyousefi 241122 review and authors response from previous submission.pdf) is included as an appendix within this file.

8. Participants and Signatories

General Participants and Signatories Section Guidance: Use the 'add link' below to enter the participant's or Signatory's details and invite them to participate in this application.

The applicant is required to supply the names and email addresses (if not already registered on ARAMIS) of the individuals who will be undertaking '**Participant**' and '**Signatory**' roles as part of the application. Please note that it is acceptable for the 'Head of Department' signatory to also act as a mentor (Participant). If this is the case, they will need to be included in this section for both roles.

Once the applicant has supplied their details, Participants and Signatories will be asked to confirm their participation, and in doing so acknowledge their involvement and input into this application and agree to be involved in it.

All Participants and Signatories must confirm participation before the application is submitted.

You must ensure that all participants and signatories are happy for your application to be submitted before submitting it online.

Signatories must also approve your application after you select the 'submit' option but BEFORE the application submission deadline.

Title	Professor	**Address Line 1**	
First Name	Rachel	**Address Line 2**	
Last Name	Hiller	**Address Line 3**	
Date of Birth		**County**	
Nationality	Australian	**Postcode**	

Education

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department

Employment

From	To	Position	Organisation

Publications

Publication Details	Date Published

Grants

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

Title	Dr	**Address Line 1**	
First Name	Ruth	**Address Line 2**	
Last Name	O'Shaughnessy	**Address Line 3**	
Date of Birth		**County**	
Nationality	Irish	**Postcode**	

Education

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department

Employment

From	To	Position	Organisation

Publications

Publication Details	Date Published

Grants

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

Title	Professor	**Address Line 1**	Wohl Clinical Neuroscience Building
First Name	Carmine	**Address Line 2**	Cutcombe Road
Last Name	Pariante	**Address Line 3**	
Date of Birth		**County**	
Nationality	British	**Postcode**	SE5 9RT

Education

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department

Employment

From	To	Position	Organisation

Publications

Publication Details	Date Published

Grants

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

Title	Professor	**Address Line 1**	Eleanor Rathbone Building
First Name	Helen	**Address Line 2**	Bedford Street South
Last Name	Sharp	**Address Line 3**	
Date of Birth		**County**	Merseyside
Nationality	British	**Postcode**	L69 7ZA

Education

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department

Employment

From	To	Position	Organisation

Publications

Publication Details	Date Published

Grants

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

Partner Organisation Representative Label

Partner Organisation Representative

Title	Ms
First Name	megan
Last Name	munnelly
Position	Grants and Bids Manager

Title	Mrs	**Address Line 1**	Gower Street
First Name	Kasia	**Address Line 2**	
Last Name	Haremza	**Address Line 3**	
Date of Birth		**County**	
Nationality		**Postcode**	WC1 6BT

Education

From	To	Qualification	Subject	Country	Institution	Class	Department

Employment

From	To	Position	Organisation

Publications

Publication Details	Date Published

Grants

Date (mm/yyyy)	Source	Prize	Role of Applicant

Signatories

Contracting Organisation

Head of Department

Title	Professor
First Name	Peter
Last Name	Fonagy
Position	Head of Division

Signatories must also approve your application after you select the 'submit' option but BEFORE the application submission deadline.

The signatory approval from your 'Head of Department' will result in the application being fully submitted to the NIHR. All parties (applicant, participants and signatory) will be notified of this via an automated system-generated email.

9. Acknowledgement, Review and Submit

Potential Conflict checks: Please declare any conflicts or potential conflicts of interest that you may have in undertaking this Fellowship, including any relevant, non-personal & commercial interest that could be perceived as a conflict of interest.
I have no conflict to declare.

Please Note - Only the Lead Applicant can submit the application.

By completing this form, the programme reserves the right to share, in confidence, details of your application with other parts of the NIHR and with the Department of Health and Social Care.

Agreement to Terms and Conditions: I confirm that I have secured all necessary licences and ethical approvals in relation to the research and will abide by the terms of those licences and approvals in carrying out the research. I confirm that I have read the NIHR Carbon Reduction Guidelines and, where possible, have taken steps to reduce the carbon emissions generated by this research. I confirm that all material within this application, with the exception of sections that other participants are required to complete, is my work and I have taken steps to ensure that no parts of the application have been inappropriately plagiarised. I undertake to conduct the research according to such guidelines for good research practice as the Host Organisation may from time to time lay down according to the NIHR Research Governance Framework. In completing this, I declare that, to the best of my knowledge, the information provided in this application, is true, accurate and complete. I have read the Guidance Notes and agree to accept the process by which an application is assessed and agree to abide by the conditions under which an award may be granted.
☒Confirmed

10. Validation Summary

Professor Peter Fonagy (Head of Department)

Please follow the next steps in order to complete your application submission process;

- **'Validate'** all mandatory/required fields listed below (that are required to be completed/amended before submitting)
- Click **'Save and Close'**
- Click the **'Submit'** option

Applications for the DSE will be reviewed three times a year. Please make sure your application is submitted before the current submission window closes on Friday 22nd November 2024 at 1pm in order to be considered in the next review period. Please refer to the Guidance notes for more information on submission windows.

You will receive an automated email containing an acknowledgement that we have received your application.

Application is valid

If there are no validation requirements above you may be ready to submit the application. To do so '**Save and Close**' the application.

Please note that your application will not be considered complete until all participants and signatories have confirmed their participation and completed any required sections of the application form.

When all required actions are completed the 'Submit' button will become visible and can be used by the applicant. The application will not be fully submitted to the NIHR until all signatories have approved the application post-submission by the applicant. All parties (applicant, participants and signatory) will be notified of this via an automated system-generated email.

Appendices

1. Alyousefi 241122 Research Plan v2.0.pdf
2. Alyousefi 241122 Career Development Programme.V3.0.pdf
3. Gantt chart DSE award - K Alyousefi-van Dijk.pdf
4. ICTU letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - Jul 2024) - signed.pdf
5. UCL (host) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024) signed.pdf
6. AFC (partner) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024).pdf
7. Prof Rachel Hiller (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 21.11.2024) signed.pdf
8. Alyousefi 241122 Narrative CV Personal Career Development Awards(2).pdf
9. Alyousefi 241122 review and authors response from previous submission.pdf

Appendix #1: Alyousefi 241122 Research Plan v2.0.pdf

Research Plan

Personal Career Development Awards

This template should be used to provide your Research Plan (*the area of research in which you will develop your research career)*.

The word limit for your Research Plan is 500 words (not including this introductory guidance).

Perinatal mental health (478 words)

Pregnancy and the arrival of a new baby often represent a time of profound change and for some families, it can be a challenging period that is further complicated by mental illness. In fact, mental health difficulties during pregnancy and up to two years after birth (i.e. the perinatal period) affect up to 27% of the birthing population[1,2,3] with suicide being the leading cause of maternal death in the UK[4]. Untreated perinatal mental health difficulties are a huge public health issue costing UK society £8.1b per year, and most of these costs (72%) relate to the burden of poor long-term outcomes for the children involved[5]. The reasons for this are thought to be, in part, the negative effect of disadvantage and parental ill health on the quality of parent-child interactions[6,7].

Since 2016, the UK has seen a remarkable uprise of NHS specialist community perinatal mental health services (PMHS) which support 10% of the most unwell parents (an estimated 66,000 in 2023/24) through interdisciplinary teams that offer a wide range of services[8]. Although PMHS now provide various evidence-based treatments across the UK, serious access difficulties as well as engagement challenges for disadvantaged and marginalised parents remain[9,10], adding to the poor representation in the clinical trials. Alongside other solutions proposed in the NHS Advancing Mental Health Equalities Strategy, the available support requires substantial improvements to become trauma-informed and culturally-sensitive[11,12,3].

In addition, parental experiences of childhood maltreatment (i.e. physical or emotional abuse and neglect, and sexual abuse) are known to contribute significantly to mental ill health across generations. In the UK, around 27% of adults in the general population have experienced maltreatment in childhood[13], which has in turn been shown to relate to later parenting stress and dysfunctional parent-child interactions[14,15,16,17]. We have recently found that the prevalence of significant childhood maltreatment experiences is closer to 75% for parents with an impaired bond with their

baby who are seen by PMHS across England[18] which is in line with other secondary mental health services supporting those with serious mental illness[19,20]. Currently, there is a strong need for the development, testing and implementation of targeted interventions supporting the parent-infant relationship for those who present with complex mental health and relational difficulties[3].

Importantly, our recent findings indicate that the combination of parental experienced childhood maltreatment, disadvantage and marginalisation explains a quarter of the variance in perinatal mental difficulties, which in turn impact the parent-infant relationship[18]. Importantly, our findings show that parents with the most severe experience of maltreatment will likely require specialised relational support that is transdiagnostic and parent-infant specific in addition to their general mental health treatment, and that if disturbances in the parent-infant relationship are not addressed, the mental health outcomes for the parent, and possibly the child, will likely be poorer[21]. Co-produced and cross-sector research in this field is needed to address the gaps in evidence for supporting the most at-risk families.

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Appendix #2: Alyousefi 241122 Career Development Programme.V3.0.pdf

Career Development Programme

Personal Career Development Awards

You are required to produce and upload a Career Development Programme as part of your application.

Please use this template to detail your career development programme. Do not add any additional headings or change the headings provided. If a heading is not applicable to your career development programme, leave it blank.

There is a limit of 1600 words for your career development programme. The limit does not include these instructions. The word limit is for your career development programme as a whole, you may decide what and how much to include under each heading.

Training courses

The proposed courses have been selected based on gaps in my current skillset, such as advanced statistical modelling and substantial training on the development and delivery of clinical trials using complex interventions. Additionally, a suite of training on emerging fields that are vital to the ever-developing landscape of clinical trials are included, such as implementation science, participatory research and impactful dissemination.

I plan to complete the following courses:

- Contemporary Clinical Trial Course
  Imperial Clinical Trials Unit, hybrid delivery across 13 weeks
- Sample size calculations in randomised clinical trials: Beyond the basics
  UCL, 7 hours + 14 hours independent study
- Behavioural Science and Complex Interventions
  University of Oxford, hybrid delivery across 4-6 weeks
- Introduction to R (Online)
  UCL, 6 hours
- Introduction to Dealing with Missing Data (Online)
  UCL, 6 hours
- Structural Equation Modelling in R workshop
  University of Cambridge, 5 full days

I also plan to complete the following self-paced online learning which are either freely accessible or I have access to as a UCL member of staff:

Dissemination and implementation

- Implementation Science Training (NIHR ARC)
- Impact beyond academia
- Engagement & Impact: planning for impact

Networking

- Enabling effective conversations with non-academics
- Networking skills
- Nature Masterclass: Networking for researchers
- Nature Masterclass: Leading a collaboration

Leadership

- Nature Masterclass: Demystifying grant budgets
- Nature Masterclass: Finding funding opportunities
- Nature Masterclass: Persuasive grant writing

PPIE

- Public Involvement Training (Imperial College London)
- Working with People and Communities to Improve Health Outcomes (NHS England)
- Applying Participatory Approaches in Public Health Settings (Imperial College London)
- The Writing Series: publishing outside academia

Placements

In parallel to the training programme, I will complete five consecutive 4-to-6-month placements with globally renowned experts in:

- clinical trial methodology;
- disadvantage in perinatal mental health and implementation science;
- applied research in complex intergenerational trauma;
- perinatal neuroscience & dissemination;
- parenting and child development across cultures and socio-economic status.

Additionally, a self-directed 6th placement under the guidance of my primary academic supervisor is woven throughout the duration of the award and includes self-paced skills training as well as dedicated writing time.

First placement – Clinical Trials

I will deepen my understanding of clinical trials incorporating complex interventions through a 6-month placement with the Imperial Clinical Trials Unit (ICTU), under the supervision of Professor Victoria Cornelius. The agreed, tailored placement includes:

- A guaranteed place in ICTU's 13-week Contemporary Clinical Trial Course
- 1-2 supervision sessions per month (with additional sessions during the course)
- Exposure to CTU and trial-specific processes
- Hands-on experience of pre-award activities such as protocol development, reviewing grant submissions and creation of budgets under the supervision of the senior operations management team, led by Dr Daphne Babalis
- Meeting ICTU Senior Management team to understand the structure of the unit and how it functions
- Grant work up through working with ICTU Operations and Statistical staff
- Linking with trial managers and oversight committees of current live trials within my field
- A session with the ICTU Head of Quality Assurance to understand risk-related approaches in clinical trials and quality management systems

During the placement, I will also be able to attend various meetings:

- ICTU Forum
- ICTU Design clinics, specifically the newly founded 'child health' design clinic
- ICTU Therapeutic Area Peer Review Groups
- ICTU Statistical Seminars and journal clubs

Second placement – Disadvantage and perinatal mental health

To gain more insight into the running of a large, diverse and award-winning NHS PMHS, I will spend a 4-month placement in the Cheshire and Merseyside Specialist Perinatal Service, mentored by Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy. During the placement, I will learn about the exemplary work this team has done in understanding and improving access to clinical services by disadvantaged parents, as well as their trauma-informed and culturally sensitive approaches to clinical research. Importantly, I will also focus on increasing my understanding of barriers and facilitators to successful implementation of parent-infant relational support in NHS PMHS and in wider support services for disadvantaged parents.

I will attend meetings with and present NIHR Advanced Fellowship ideas to:

- Perinatal Equalities Advisory Group Meeting
- Staff training – opening up conversations about race and difference
- Halton Family Hub

Third placement – Applied research in complex intergenerational trauma

To build expertise in applied research, using cutting-edge mixed methods and co-production designs, I will complete a 4-month placement under the supervision of Professor Rachel Hiller at UCL and the Anna Freud Centre. Learnings from her as well as from the teams working on the MRC's ADaPT trial (Assessment and Delivery

of PTSD Treatments for care-experienced young people) and the NIHR ARC's ReThink trial (A longitudinal investigation of the mental health and wellbeing of care-experienced young people), will aid my knowledge and skills needed to design and deliver cross-sector research. Importantly, this placement will greatly impact my ability to design and deliver applied research in sectors with limited research capacity and knowledge, in a trauma-informed and co-produced way.

I will attend meetings with and present NIHR Advanced Fellowship ideas to:

- Parent and child advisory groups
- Child Trauma and Recovery Research Group
- Child Attachment and Psychological Therapies Research (CHAPTRe) Unit

Please see the support letter for more details. Additionally, I will attend the monthly UK Trauma Council Insight Series.

Fourth placement – Perinatal neuroscience and dissemination

In order to advance my clinical knowledge of perinatal mental illness, as well as the neurobiology underlying these difficulties, I will complete a 4-month placement with Professor Carmine Pariante at King's College London (KCL). In Professor Pariante' Stress Psychiatry and Immunology Laboratory I will join the project Happymums, which aims to understand predictors of depression in pregnancy. I will have access to a large dataset of women at risk for depression in pregnancy with biological and clinical data including active and passive data from a dedicated app. In addition to this research experience, I will also work in the mental health digital magazine Inspire the Mind (approximately 50k views per year) where I will learn to write for the lay public on topics relevant to perinatal mental health and I will learn how to use social media as well as podcasts and video communications.

I will attend meetings with and present NIHR advanced fellowship ideas to:

- Stress, Psychiatry and Immunology lab Professional Development meetings
- Editorial meetings of the Inspire the Mind digital magazine
- KCL clinical trial office meetings

Fifth placement - Parenting and child development across cultures and socio-economic status

To guarantee clinical relevance and cultural sensitivity of the parent-infant relational work I intend to undertake in the advanced fellowship, I will complete a 4-month placement with Professor Helen Sharp at Liverpool University. During the placement, I will attend the parent-infant research team meetings and meet with key people to hear about their work of engaging a diverse range of parents in clinical and academic work. Importantly, I will observe a project on early parenting and school

readiness in Pakistani, Indian and poor white British children in the UK using data collected from the children of the 2020s birth cohort study. Additionally, Professor Sharp will have completed dataset on observational parenting data in India from the Bangalore Child Health and Development study from pregnancy to age 7 years which will provide rich insights into the role of early parenting and parental mental health on child development with cross-cultural comparison to a sister cohort in the UK (Wirral child health and development study), both with high levels of socio-economic disadvantage.

During the placement, Professor Sharp will arrange for me to present fellowship ideas to the Faculty of Perinatal Psychology executive group for feedback on clinical relevance. Additionally, she will convene a group of clinical academic experts in the field to provide feedback on the fellowship proposal. Additionally, I will attend the following meetings during the placement:

- Parent-infant research team meetings
- Bangalore-UK study meetings (if funding is continued)
- Family Nurse Partnership Supervision meetings

Sixth placement – Dissemination, Implementation, Leadership and PPIE (self-directed)

A sixth placement is woven through the full award duration and will include:

- Training (see previous section).
- Dedicated time for writing and publishing a literature review of suitable interventions for disadvantaged parents who have experienced childhood maltreatment.
- Dedicated writing time for a NIHR Advanced Fellowship proposal (building on the review) which will be submitted during or soon after this award.

The amount of time spent weekly on the latter two categories will vary across the fellowship, ranging from a minimum of 1 day/week during placements, to the full FTE of the award outside of placements. All placements will provide valuable learning that will feed into both the literature review as well as the proposal for the advanced fellowship. Prof Peter Fonagy will act as my primary academic supervisor during the award, see host support letter.

Building Collaborations

This award will provide an unparalleled opportunity for building new collaborations across institutions and with teams who successfully work internationally. All mentors involved in this proposal are hugely successful leaders in the field who have extensive experience supervising fellows and early career researchers. Collectively,

they cover all content expertise, skillsets and leadership qualities that are needed for me to successfully progress to the next stage of my career. Each of the mentors and supervisors will also make world-class partners on future grant applications.

Conferences

I plan to attend the international conference of the World Association for Infant Mental Health in 2026. In addition to the results from the NIHR HTA COSI trial, I also plan to present the (preliminary) findings of the literature review conducted during this award. Additionally, I will attend the prestigious international Marce society conference in 2026 that hosts the world's leading experts on perinatal mental health during which I plan to present my work on perinatal mental health in parents exposed to trauma and disadvantage.

Other

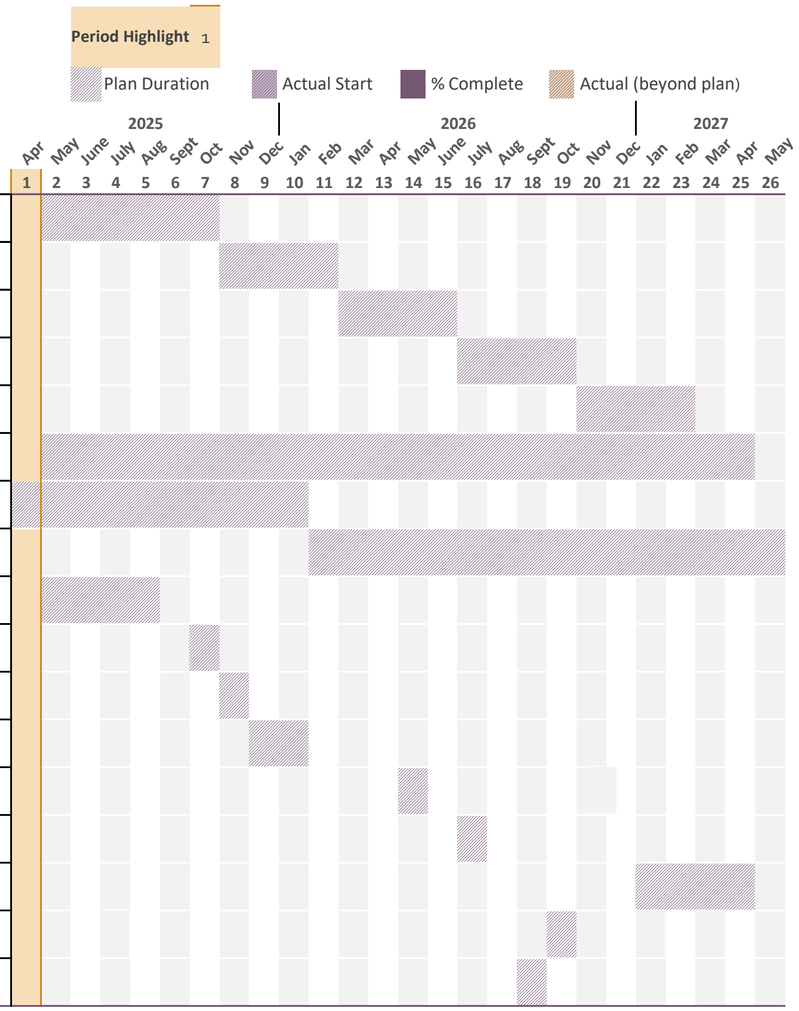
Appendix #3: Gantt chart DSE award - K Alyousefi-van Dijk.pdf

NIHR DSE Award - Dr Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk

Period Highlight 1

Plan Duration | Actual Start | % Complete | Actual (beyond plan)

AREA	ACTIVITY	LOCATION	PLAN START	PLAN DURATION
Placements	Clinical Trials - Prof Victoria Cornelius	Imperial Clinical Trials Unit	2	6
	Disatvantage and perinatal mental health - Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy	Cheshire and Merseyside Specialist Perinatal Service	8	4
	Applied research in complex intergenerational trauma - Prof Rachel Hiller	University College London	12	4
	Perinatal neuroscience & dissemination - Prof Carmine Pariante	King's College London	16	4
	Parenting and child development across cultures and socio-economic status - Prof Helen Sharp	University of Liverpool	20	4
Self-directed career development	Self-paced training (see Career Development Programme)	Various	2	24
	Protected writing time for literature review	University College London	1	10
	Protected writing time for NIHR Advanced Fellowship	University College London	11	16
Courses	Contemporary Clinical Trial Course	Imperial Clinical Trials Unit	2	4
	Introduction to R	University College London	7	1
	Structural Equation Modelling in R workshop	University of Cambridge	8	1
	Behavioural Science and Complex Interventions	University of Oxford	9	2
	Introduction to Dealing with Missing Data	University College London	14	1
	Sample size calculations in randomised clinical trials: Beyond the basics	University College London	16	1
	UK Trauma Council Insight Series	Anna Freud Centre	22	4
Conferences	Biennial World World Association for Infant Mental Health conference	Toronto, Canada	19	1
	Biennial International Marce conference	TBA	18	1



Appendix #4: ICTU letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - Jul 2024) - signed.pdf

Imperial College London

Imperial Clinical Trials Unit (ICTU)
Imperial College London
68 Wood Lane
London W12 7RH, UK

Dr Victoria Cornelius
Director, Imperial Clinical Trials Unit

22/07/2024

Dear NIHR,

RE: Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk, NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Application 2024

The Imperial Clinical Trials Unit (ICTU) has agreed to host Kim at the unit during her DSE award to support her development and learning particularly in relation to clinical trials incorporating complex interventions. She will have access to the unit over six months to acquire knowledge and skills across various clinical trial aspects. We have collaborated with Kim to devise a comprehensive activity programme for her placement, as detailed below.

I have agreed to act as a statistical mentor and will meet Kim 1-2 times per month to guide her self-learning during the ICTU placement. Kim will also spend dedicated time with members of the ICTU operational, data management and statistical teams to give her a broad range of insights into designing and delivering efficient clinical trials which can be applied to her own research. Dr Daphne Babalis, ICTU Director of Operations will provide guidance and work with Kim to identify opportunities to gain hands-on experience of pre-award activities such as protocol development, reviewing grant submissions and creation of study budgets. In addition, Kim will be invited to participate in ICTU statistical seminars, trial design meetings, forums for operational and regulatory issues, and peer review committee meetings throughout her placement.

Kim will attend the ICTU Contemporary Clinical Trial Course in person course. The overall aim of the course is to provide a foundational understanding of how clinical trials are run, what's involved in the process and the different types of designs that can be used. The course will be a mixture of online material and face to face small group tutorials that are designed to help the participants improve their understanding of clinical trials and apply what they learn to their research. The tutorials will be led by experienced clinical trialists working at ICTU who will be on hand to provide guidance as required.

I hope this letter shows our strong commitment to supporting Kim. We look forward to working with her and ensuring her training and future development.

Yours Sincerely,

Victoria Cornelius

ICTU Placement: Draft program

• **Attendance at unit meetings:**
○ ICTU Forum (for 'hot topics' in clinical trials) - monthly
○ ICTU Statistical Seminars - monthly
○ ICTU Collaboration Committee design clinic (during grant work up)
○ ICTU Therapeutic Area Peer Review Groups (during grant work up)
• **Meet the ICTU Senior Management team:** to understand the structure of the unit and how it functions.
• **QA:** Session with the ICTU Head of QA to understand risk-based approaches in clinical trials, the quality management system, and the importance of SOPs.
• **Oversight Committees:** Experience the conduct of studies through observations of DMC and TSC meetings of live trials in field of interest.
• **Grant work up:** Working with ICTU Operations and Statistical staff at the design, grant/ protocol development stage.
• **Trial costs:** Working with an ICTU Operations Manager to cost a proposal.
• **Trial management:** Sessions with trial managers working on live trials in field of interest.

Appendix #5: UCL (host) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024) signed.pdf

PSYCHOLOGY & LANGUAGE SCIENCES
Professor Peter Fonagy
Head of Division

Division of Psychology and Language Sciences
University College London
26 Bedford Way
WC1H 0AP
London

Tuesday 19 November 2024

RE: Letter of support for Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk's application for the NIHR Development and Skills enhancement award

Dear Members of the Committee,

I am writing to enthusiastically recommend Dr. Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk for the NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award. As a distinguished member of the Division of Psychology and Language Sciences (PaLS) at University College London (UCL), she has consistently shown exceptional dedication, intellectual rigor, and a deep commitment to advancing clinical research in child and perinatal psychology.
Dr. Alyousefi-van Dijk's academic background is outstanding. Her Ph.D., which bridges neuroscience and psychology, has led to an impressive number of publications in renowned journals and presentations at international conferences. Since joining UCL as a postdoctoral research fellow in 2021, Dr. Alyousefi-van Dijk has actively contributed to several high-impact research projects and has fostered excellent relationships across various teams, disciplines, and organizations. Her innovative approach to conducting clinical trials at the highest academic standard, while creating collaborative and inclusive environments across sectors, is truly commendable. Her recent work focussing on the effects of deprivation and marginalization on perinatal well-being is particularly exemplary given that she has been able to successfully integrate seldom-heard voices in every aspect of the work. Her continuous efforts to advance not only her own career, but the careers of all those she works with, is evidenced by the number of influential publications being written up by students she supervises, as well as the PPIE staff presenting their work at the ARC North Thames Mental Health for All event this September.

She would be hosted by one of the foremost universities and, in her area of work, the leading department of psychology in the UK. UCL, recognised as the Times University of the Year 2024, was ranked second in the UK for research power in the Research Excellence Framework 2021. PaLS is consistently ranked globally among the top five for psychology due to its exceptional performance across all aspects of the discipline. To support Dr. Alyousefi-van Dijk's interest in the interface of neuroscience, development, and clinical application, UCL's PaLS is exceptionally well placed. It is the top-ranked university

for research power according to REF and hosts Europe's largest and most popular training programmes in clinical psychology, as well as other mental health care trainings. We are able to integrate her into our world-leading research teams and thriving fellowship support networks, creating a productive environment for early-stage researchers.

Importantly, I am more than happy to act as her primary academic supervisor and to oversee her general progress. More specifically I will meet with her regularly throughout the award, specifically in relation to her dedicated writing time for an NIHR Advanced Fellowship proposal as well as a literature review to support this proposal. I will assist in making sure she has ringfenced time to complete everything included in the DSE application. In addition to my role as the head of the Division of PaLS at UCL, I am also a Clinical Advisor to the UCLPartners Integrated Mental Health Programme, National Clinical Advisor of the NHS England Children and Young People's Mental Health programme, the Leader of the Mental Health theme in the North Thames Applied Health Research Collaboration, and a Senior Investigator Emeritus for NIHR. I have occupied various key national leadership positions including Chair of the Outcomes Measurement Reference Group at the Department of Health, Chair of two NICE Guideline Development Groups, and co-chaired the Department of Health's Expert Reference Group on Vulnerable Children. I was appointed Officer of the Order of the British Empire (OBE) in the 2013 Birthday Honours for services to psychoanalysis and clinical psychology and has been honoured as a Commander of the Order of the British Empire (CBE) for my services to mental health care for children and young people in 2024. I will be ideally placed to not only provide support and supervision, but also to help her integrate into UCL and various other networks.

Dr. Alyousefi-van Dijk is already a member of the North Thames Applied Research Collaboration, known for its widely admired PPIE support. This collaboration has already supported her research and will be an excellent host for the implementation science aspects of her future work. The NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award at UCL PaLS, with its well-developed integrated support system for early-stage researchers, would provide Dr. Alyousefi-van Dijk with exceptional scientific and collaborative opportunities to further develop her skills and expand her independent research and leadership capabilities.

The award will enable her to engage in advanced training, collaborate with leading clinical and methodological experts, and contribute to pioneering research initiatives. I have no doubt that she will utilise this opportunity to make significant progress in our understanding of child and perinatal mental health. I am confident that she will make substantial contributions to the field and continue to excel in her academic and professional endeavours.

Warm regards,

Professor Peter Fonagy CBE FMedSci FBA FAcSS
Head of the Division of Psychology and Language Sciences
National Clinical Advisor on Children's Mental Health, NHS England
P.Fonagy@ucl.ac.uk

26 Bedford Way
London
WC1H 0AP

Appendix #6: AFC (partner) letter of support (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 19.11.2024).pdf

Anna Freud

Date: 20 November 2024

Letter of support/commitment

To whom it may concern,

We are writing to confirm Anna Freud's support for hosting the proposed NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement award led by Dr Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk.

Anna Freud is a world-leading mental health charity for children and families. For over 70 years we have championed research and channelled it into clinical practice and dissemination. Our mission is to close the gaps in science, implementation and access to knowledge. We do this in part through lived experience and community participation, testing and improving inclusive and pragmatic interventions and disseminating accessible knowledge about what works.

Kim has been a valuable member of staff since March 2021 and has made significant contributions to the testing and evaluation of clinical interventions. Kim has also successfully and sensitively led the meaningful incorporation of lived experiences voices in all aspects of research. As an organisation, Anna Freud is keen to support her development and provide her with an honorary contract for the duration of the award. We fully support her application to the NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement award.

Thank you for this opportunity. We look forward to hearing the outcome of the application.

Yours sincerely,

Prof Eamon McCrory, current CEO

Appendix #7: Prof Rachel Hiller (DSE - Alyousefi-van Dijk - 21.11.2024) signed.pdf

London's Global University

UCL

Dear Panel,

This letter confirms my strong support for Kim Alyousefi-Van Dujk's application to the NIHR DSE scheme. It would be my pleasure to act as one of Kim's mentors in my capacity as Professor of Child & Adolescent Mental Health and head of the UCL Child Trauma and Recovery research group at UCL and as Co-Director of the UK Trauma Council (a project of the Anna Freud).

Funded by multiple NIHR and MRC grants, I lead and mentor a large research team across UCL and Anna Freud, of postdoctoral researchers, research assistants, trial managers, paid interns, and postgraduate students. We have monthly full-lab meetings, which include standing items on career development, which Kim would be welcome to attend. I also meet with all lab members individually on a monthly basis, to focus in on their career development needs, which I would also be very happy to offer to Kim. This includes considering areas on their CV for growth (e.g., papers, grant applications, conferences), and a focus on building their skills in their specific areas of interest (for example, some are particularly interested in policy impact). I have supported multiple team members with grant and fellowship development, to funders such as UKRI, NIHR, and Wellcome. Team members have gone on to secure academic posts, clinical training posts (e.g., DClinPsy), and research positions in national third-sector organisations. My research is also highly interdisciplinary, including collaborations with academic colleagues from social work, policy, and education fields. Kim would of course be welcome to join meetings with these colleagues and I would be happy to facilitate introductions to support Kim's development in this area.

Sincerely,

Rachel Hiller, PhD

Professor in Child & Adolescent Mental Health

Co-Director UK Trauma Council

Co-Head of Postgraduate Studies, UCL-Anna Freud partnership

Treasurer, International Society for Traumatic Stress Studies

Appendix #8: Alyousefi 241122 Narrative CV Personal Career Development Awards(2).pdf

NIHR | National Institute for Health and Care Research

Narrative CV
Personal Career Development Awards

This template is intended to provide a flexible framework that allows you to showcase relevant skills and experience to support your application and demonstrate your ability to successfully deliver the proposed work. The template contains five modules.

- Contributions to the generation of new ideas, tools, methodologies, or knowledge.
- Contributions to the development of others and maintenance of effective working relationships.
- Contributions to the wider research and innovation community.
- Contributions to broader society.

- Your suitability for the award

Relevant skills and experience will differ depending on the opportunity to which you are applying. You should describe a selection of past contributions that best evidence your ability to carry out the proposed work. Please refer to the guidance for each module to inform the content of your narrative CV.

The word limit for your narrative CV is 1,500 words (not including this introductory guidance). Within this word count, you can include as much information as you like within each module.

Module 1 – Contributions to the generation of new ideas, tools, methodologies or knowledge

At the start of my career, I worked as a research assistant on a multi-centre clinical trial in Amsterdam, the Netherlands, examining the effectiveness of an endcrinological intervention aimed at preventing the development of stress-related psychopathology. By leading participant recruitment and data collection, I contributed to influential findings about relevant endocrinologial and neural mechanisms. Following this, I worked for the Dutch Brain Bank for Psychiatry, where I co-led participant recruitment and psychiatric interviewing of prospective brain donors. The data collected from this project have been used in multiple international research projects, including a recently funded 23-million-euro project aiming to create a brain atlas for psychiatry.

I then completed a PhD at the Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, in which I conducted multiple randomised controlled trials testing behavioural and endocrinological interventions, leading me to **publish 15 peer-reviewed papers in renowned academic journals to date**. As part of my PhD, I developed a parenting intervention for expectant fathers using ultrasound images called the Prenatal Video-feedback Intervention to promote Positive Parenting (VIPP-PRE). The findings indicated that VIPP-PRE is feasible, acceptable and effective in improving parenting quality. My findings also indicated that fathers who have been maltreated in their own childhood showed inadequate inhibitory control over their behavioural responses towards infant crying and that this effect is dependent on low structural

connectivity in the brain. **I was recently acknowledged as a top cited author publishing in the Infant Mental Health Journal (2022/2023).**

After my PhD I have led evaluations of clinical interventions at the Anna Freud Centre (a national child mental health research charity), such as a feasibility study for an online support group for adoptive families, a therapeutic group for women who experienced multiple removals, as well as a mental health service for fathers. In 2023, I was awarded an NIHR-ARC-funded Springboard grant as a Chief Investigator of the CAEP study, examining the effects of socio-economic disadvantage and parental experienced childhood maltreatment on perinatal mental health and family relationships in over 300 women and birthing parents under the care of NHS Perinatal Mental Health Services (PMHS). Importantly, I led the co-production of an innovative coding framework aiming to account for the intersectional effects of multiple types of disadvantages and early trauma that impact parents and children. The pre-registration of the upcoming publication of this framework and the results of the wider CAEP study, both of which I lead as a first author, can be found here. In addition, we recently submitted our findings on mental health and parent-child relationships in women and birthing parents before and after treatment in an ethnically diverse NHS PMHS for publication. Since 2021, I have been the trial manager for the NIHR-HTA-funded COSI trial which examines the clinical and cost-effectiveness of a group parenting programme in 10 geographically spread NHS PMHS that have historically been underrepresented in clinical research and have relatively little research capacity.

Module 2 – Contributions to the development of others and maintenance of effective working relationships

In the past 10 years, I have supervised both EU and UK-based research projects of over 20 undergraduate, graduate and doctoral students. I also coordinated a Research Masters course at Leiden University, the Netherlands for two academic years. I have taught many research skills internationally, e.g. I was invited to the University of Gdanks in Poland to teach parent-infant observational skills to students and senior research staff. In 2024, I supervised a DClinPsy student at the University of East London and mentored an NIHR-ARC-funded Career Development Fellow. Currently, I lead weekly seminars for undergraduate Psychology students at University College London during which I teach a variety of academic and professional skills. I have successfully line-managed interdisciplinary research teams and am known for creating compassionate, inclusive and efficient environments in which all members of the team thrive.

Module 3 – Contributions to the wider research community

As part of my contributions to the wider research community, I review manuscripts for high-impact journals (e.g. Trials, Frontiers) regularly. Additionally, I am a member of the Society for Reproductive and Infant Psychology, as well as the International Society of Psychoneuroendocrinology. I have presented my PhD findings at multiple conferences, e.g. International Congress of Neuroendocrinology (Toronto, Canada, 2018), Social Neuroscience of Human Attachment (Essex, UK, 2020) and Society for Research in Child

Development (St. Louis, USA, 2021). In addition, I have given invited talks at symposia and seminars at the University of Cambridge and University of Oxford. In 2024 I was given a full conference bursary to chair and talk at a symposium during the Annual Conference of the Society for Reproductive and Infant Psychology in Dresden, Germany.

Module 4 – Contributions to broader society

Recently, I participated in a podcast discussing my PhD findings in a way that is accessible and relevant to parents. My current role at the Anna Freud Centre, a leading family mental health charity, has allowed me to widen my knowledge of co-production and accessible dissemination. As a result, I lead a team in which parents with lived experience of mental health difficulties are involved in every part of the research, including grant application, analysis and dissemination. Collaboratively, we are creating an accessible and clinically helpful breakdown of research findings which in turn informs the practice of screening women and birthing parents accessing PMHS for mental health and parent-child difficulties in a trauma-informed manner that includes an understanding of how intersectionality and adverse childhood experiences can affect families.

Module 5 - Your suitability for the award

I am an early career researcher with 11 years of experience in the end-to-end delivery of clinical studies in the field of child and perinatal mental health. I started my career as a neuroscientist and in more recent years moved towards my true passion: the pragmatic real-life testing of complex behavioural interventions. Despite developing many skills in this area over the past few years, the nature of contracted project funding for my recent roles has meant that the delivery of the project I was working on at the time needed to be prioritised over my personal career development. This excluded possibilities such as attending costly and time-consuming training courses, writing fellowship applications and establishing new collaborations.

The goal of this award is to successfully start the transition from a project-funded early career researcher delivering clinical trials to obtaining a competitive permanent academic position leading to a professorship and leading on project grant submissions. The step-wise approach of this trajectory is:
- The DSE award, which includes the write-up of a NIHR Advanced Fellowship and a supporting literature review on treatments for disadvantaged parents who have experienced childhood maltreatment
- The NIHR Advanced Fellowship award, which will include a substantial research project on the same topic, and allow for dedicated time to contribute to various project grants as a co-applicant (founded upon collaborations formed during the DSE and Advanced Fellowship award)
- A permanent substantive academic post during which I will be able to submit project grants as a lead applicant, e.g. NIHR HTA grants examining the clinical and cost-effectiveness of therapies for NHS PMHS

My track record of academic achievements and high-quality project delivery shows that I am a committed, enthusiastic and skilled applicant who is not only able to deliver the proposed award to a high standard but who will also become an influential leader in a field that is in need of clinical researchers who can work across disciplines and sectors in order to reduce health inequalities affecting families.

Appendix #9: Alyousefi 241122 review and authors response from previous submission.pdf

Summary of review from previous submission

Summary

Reference Number NIHR305716
Lead Applicant Dr Kim Alyousefi-van Dijk
Research Title NIHR Development and Skills Enhancement Award
Total Research Cost 120,496.00

Please find the response from the lead applicant below in red underlined text.

Reviewer 1

Person Score 5/6

The applicant is a research scientist with considerable research experience for her career level; 15 publications (4 as first author), limited grant income but contextual factors given to justify this. Gained an NIHR ARC funded springboard grant and demonstrates a strong commitment to research with a focus on testing complex behavioural interventions to improve child and perinatal mental health. Her future research trajectory is less well defined in the application with no ring fenced time allocated to develop a future fellowship or grant proposal.

I thank the reviewer for their positive feedback and the helpful suggestions for improvements. The re-submission now addresses my career trajectory in more detail. As noted in the application, the goal of this award is to successfully start the transition from a project-funded early career researcher delivering clinical trials to obtaining a competitive permanent academic position leading to a professorship and leading on project grant submissions. The step-wise approach of this trajectory is:

- The DSE award, which includes the write-up of a NIHR Advanced Fellowship and a supporting literature review on treatments for disadvantaged parents who have experienced childhood maltreatment
- The NIHR Advanced Fellowship award, which will include a substantial research project on the same topic, and allow for dedicated time to contribute to various project grants as a co-applicant (founded upon collaborations formed during the DSE and Advanced Fellowship award)
- A permanent substantive academic post during which I will be able to submit project grants as a lead applicant, e.g. NIHR HTA grants examining the clinical and cost-effectiveness of therapies for NHS PMHS

As is now stated in the application, my primary academic supervisor (Prof Fonagy, UCL) will monitor and help protect the dedicated writing time in the self-paced 6th placement which is woven throughout the duration of the DSE award.

I have also added a grant that I obtained shortly after the previous submission.

Training & Development Proposal Score 5/6

A well thought through, ambitious training plan that is structured into four, 6 month placements. The proposed placements and courses focus on innovative trial methods, statistical modelling,

intergenerational transmission or trauma, leaderships skills and the development of a multi-disciplinary network. For the most part the placements are well aligned with relevant courses but it is somewhat unclear what the 4th placement will entail. Future plans are less well articulated and it is unclear how the identified knowledge gaps will support a future funding application.

More details on placement 4 are now added to the proposal. In addition, a stronger explanation of how the identified gaps and proposed training fit into future applications is now added.

Sites and Supervision Score 5/6

Strong academic environments proposed in three well established UK research institutions. Relevant support and mentorship proposed from experts in clinical trials of complex interventions, child and perinatal mental health, complex trauma and statistical modelling. However collaborations are limited and it would be useful to see how the applicant intends to develop international collaborations, as well as community and public engagement.

One of the placements at my current place of employment (i.e. Anna Freud Centre with Prof Pasco Fearon) has now been removed as this indeed not a new addition to my current network. Two new placements, both with new collaborators have been added (i.e. specialist perinatal mental health service in Cheshire and Merseyside with Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy, and University of Liverpool with Prof Helen Sharp). The partnership with the Anna Freud Centre has remained in place with the main purpose of providing access to a well-established parent participation team who will be able to feed into the advanced fellowship proposal. The Anna Freud Centre's experience of community engagement and co-production approaches is world-leading and is a vital element of the proposed work. This has now been emphasised more in the proposal. A more detailed plan for the international conferences (including networking) has now also been added.

Summary 15/18

Thank you for the opportunity to review this well-presented and ambitious application. Your passion for child and perinatal mental health research is evident throughout and you propose a detailed training plan. Some more detail into your future plans following the award would be useful to understand your intended career trajectory. It would also be interesting to see how you intend to develop your previous work around integrating the voice of underserved groups to address inequalities in child and perinatal mental health.

The two new placements in the proposal have been carefully selected based on their extensive experience of working with underserved communities and world-leading approaches to reducing inequalities experienced by families. I have added more information on my own experience and relevant findings around inequalities in perinatal mental health, which were always meant to be the main focus of my career, but were not highlighted enough in the previous submission. The intersecting nature of mental health, adversity and trauma is now rightfully so brought to the foreground of the application. The additional placements will also provide crucial input for taking this work forward, e.g. by learning from various research projects and clinical work aimed understanding the effects of adversity as well as innovative approaches

to bridging current gaps in service access and increasing treatment uptake and effectiveness. Please see the new submission for the full details.

Reviewer 2

Person Score 4/6

Clinical Trials theme

18 months @ 0.7 WTE (26 months)

Post-doctoral candidate - PhD Neurobiology of early parenthood Other Research Scientist

Trial Manager Anna Freud Centre 91 03/2021 - Visiting Researcher Imperial College London 0 03/2021 - Honorary

Research Fellow University College London 0

Trials management experience, neuroscientist, wanting to balance skill set and develop in perinatal mental health. Published 14 peer-reviewed papers in renowned academic journals to date. Three first author Clear sense of potential and track record of activity. Acknowledged as top cited author publishing in the Infant Mental Health Journal (2022/2023). Not as clear as expected on career trajectory, refers to developing grants but not specific on which and not reflected in Gantt chart as yet. Note mitigating circumstances. Demonstrates commitment to research which has been the main remit of their career throughout. Host commitment to applicant post-award not stated and not convincing that there is commitment to this individual beyond further NIHR funding.

I thank the reviewer for their positive feedback and the helpful suggestions for improvements. Please see the answer to the first reviewer in relation to the career trajectory which has now been added in more detail to the proposal. This change has also been included in the GANTT chart.

Training & Development Proposal Score 4/6

Four consecutive 6-month placements with globally renowned experts in: clinical trial methodology; content expertise in intergenerational family trauma, child mental health and perinatal psychiatry; and advanced statistical modelling. Training linked to aims of DSE, therefore relevant. However almost totally London-centric, and where not, all within the golden triangle. Missed opportunity to examine needs beyond this population/geography, I would recommend revising this to expand understanding to other areas of the UK. I am unclear what NIHR award this training is leading to.

Two new placements have now been added: one in the specialist perinatal mental health service in Cheshire and Merseyside with Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy, and one at the University of Liverpool with Prof Helen Sharp. Dr Ruth O'Shaughnessy and her team have dedicated much of their work to improving service access to disadvantaged parents and have a strong and active equality taskforce. In addition, Prof Sharp leads multiple large-scale international research projects on the effects of early parenting on child development in the face of adversity, across highly deprived communities in rural India and UK. I thank the reviewer for this very helpful

suggestion and I am confident that this change will make a meaningful difference in understanding the needs of parents (and services) outside of the London area. I have now also emphasised that all of my previous work on disadvantage in perinatal mental health was conducted outside of the golden triangle and exclusively involved NHS services with little or no research experience and capacity. Moreover, the network of Experts by Experience that I work with is diverse in various ways and this has been vital to the design and interpretation of my previous work. I am committed to staying on this trajectory and being critical about representation and inclusivity.

Sites and Supervision Score 5/6

Within an organisation currently with significant track record of research/strong academic environment, including global renowned leaders. All mentors/supervisors of high quality and appropriate however again would have anticipated going beyond current organisation to expand networks, exposure and reach of collaborations.

Similar to the feedback above, the reach of collaborations has now been extended.

Summary 12/18

Reviewer 3

Person Score 4/6

An early-career application from a psychology/neurobiology applicant (completed PhD in June 2021, MSc 2014 and BSC 2011) specialising perinatal mental health. No research grants listed but CI on NIHR-ARC funded springboard. Experience of feasibility studies and NIHR HTA COSI trial. Extensive supervision experience. Currently working as a trial manager at the Anna Freud Centre. One distinction, 15 papers (4 as first author, many from PhD). On the trajectory to becoming a future leader of clinical trials in perinatal mental health. Not clear what application for future NIHR funding is planned. Research support given by Rachel Hiller and Pasco Fearon linked to the Anna Freud Centre. It is not clear what their track records are in training and supporting people who have gone on to develop successful academic careers.

I thank the reviewer for their positive feedback and the helpful suggestions for improvements. Please see the answer to the first reviewer in relation to the career trajectory which has now been added in more detail to the proposal.

The placement with Pasco Fearon has now been replaced by a new, non-London based, collaboration that constitutes an expansion of my network. The placement with Prof Rachel Hiller has stayed in the proposal as this is new connection as we have not had the change to work together before. Moreover, Prof Hiller is ideally placed to support my career development for reasons stated in the application. Her experience in supervision is now added to the proposal.

Training & Development Proposal Score 5/6

The applicant is hosted by one of the foremost universities in perinatal mental health (no change in department planned but significant time in a range of departments is planned). She is supported by senior academics from UCL, KCL, Cambridge and Imperial. She has clearly articulated the gaps in her CV and how the award will support her in filling these gaps. However, it is not clear what the next steps would be following the award.

Please see the answer to the first reviewer in relation to the career trajectory which has now been added in more detail to the proposal.

Sites and Supervision Score 6/6

The academic environment proposed is very strong and the head of department statement is very supportive (18 mths is requested at 70% WTE). The academic environment includes the entire multi-disciplinary team required to execute a successful clinical trial and the networks needed to conduct clinical trials in the specialist field in question.

Summary 15/18

Generally, I thought this was a good application. I think further articulation of steps planned following the award would be helpful.

Thank you for your kind words. Please see the answer to the first reviewer in relation to the career trajectory which has now been added in more detail to the proposal.